

Longer-term, MILCs may replace dSLRs entirely in some categories or among some manufacturers, with Olympus America's DSLR product manager speculating that by 2012, Olympus DSLRs (the Olympus E system) may be mirrorless, though still using the Four Thirds System.

It is imminent that the new compact EVIL cameras will make the dSLR cameras history. Contrast detection autofocus will eventually measure up in speed and predictive abilities to phase detection. Adapters will safeguard existing investments in dSLR lenses. So there is no reason why photographers will stick with the bulkier traditional format. If image stabilization can be achieved, there is no reason why auto object tracking will not be a standard feature one day.

The push from technological innovations tends to be inexorable. There is no reason why it will not be the case with compact dSLRs.

With a smaller camera, you can blend in. With an EVIL camera, you can blend in and still get great shots. And because there is no mirror to flip, they're quiet, too. So unless you have a specific use that these cameras can't meet, you have no reason to buy a dSLR. Instead, consider being EVIL. You might like it. 